



A review based on the ONS Labour Force Survey of 2021, published by the NCTJ, found that the number of non-white journalists was still disproportionate with the UK population. *'There is still a greater proportion of white journalists (92%) than the workforce as a whole (88%).'*¹⁵ In order to counter this imbalance, Rhona and her team actively work with BIPOC and gender queer as employees and in their editorial content.

The significance of economic factors, including commercial and not-for-profit public funding, to media industries and their products.

The 2018 Somerset House Print exhibition **Tearing it Up** was a celebration of flourishing independent magazine publishing in Britain, past and present, at a time when mainstream magazines sales dwindled. This exhibition defined independence as *'putting Ideas before profit'*, and THIIIRD as a new magazine participated. Such arts platforms are key to getting industry attention from cultural opinion leaders.

THIIIRD is an independent magazine with no direct advertising, and though this may change in future, its primary goal is not to sell the demographics of the core reader profile to get advertising revenue. It is a fashion magazine that is more of a cultural enterprise than a commercial/consumerist one, but it still needs money to exist. Rhona and her team have to be more resourceful in getting funding and have to devote time and labour to develop income streams. As an independent company, they may be eligible to benefit from cultural grants; in the past, they have received investments from local business grants and the Prince's Trust.

Rhona Ezuma's work as a stylist for mainstream brands, such as Adidas, and magazines, like Vogue and GQ, could lead to making connections with media buyers from various brands to develop new partnerships.

The fashion shoots displaying branded clothing are not affiliated or paid for, but when THIIIRD receives a commission, the editorial team are able to pay themselves a little. There is a link on the About Us page to encourage brands to get in contact for partnerships.

In 2022, the **Nike London Grant Initiative** commissioned THIIIRD to promote the ways their donations were being put to good use. Both print and web magazines were given separate fees for the advertorial content that publicised the good work the different local charities were doing for their communities, such as the S.M.I.L.E-ing Boys Project. The print issue had an extra pull out, an inside front cover gatefold, to highlight the NIKE project.

The impact of digitally convergent platforms on media production, distribution and circulation.

There is no paywall for the web magazine, so the reader can explore, visit the shop and buy back issues there as well. As of October 2023, the web magazine has about 1.9K readers per month. Social media is used to publicise new articles and news about events, drawing followers back to the magazine hub. There is a direct link to *'our IG'* on the magazine's About page. THIIIRD has nearly 6,000 Instagram followers (as of October 2023), and there are several posts a week to engage with their community, including to get involved with the production of the 7th issue of the magazine.

As a result of the pandemic, one of the international distributors THIIIRD used for online sales of the print magazine went under, and any upfront payments were lost due to the distributor's bankruptcy. THIIIRD lost money, and the future of the magazine was in jeopardy. A Crowdfunder page was set up for Issue #5, to encourage followers to invest in the print magazine

¹⁵ 13.5 2021 <https://pressgazette.co.uk/news/nctj-diversity-journalism-number-journalists/>